

IRISH HOUSING MARKET — INSIGHTS MEMO

Prepared by Adham AlHers · Data Analyst Portfolio Project · August 2026

Source: CSO Ireland Residential Property Price Index (table HPA06) and Earnings & Labour Costs release — real published data, fetched directly from the CSO PxStat API.

Headline finding

Regional Ireland — not Dublin — is where house prices are overheating fastest right now.

Region	Growth since 2020 recovery
Border (excl. Louth)	+67.7%
Midland	+64.4%
West	+56.6%
National average	+47.4%
Dublin	+38.4%
Dún Laoghaire-Rathdown	+33.4% (slowest of any region)

Why this matters

The dominant media narrative is that Dublin is where Irish house prices are hardest to manage. The data no longer supports that as the sharpest edge of the story: since the 2020 recovery, border and midland counties have grown nearly twice as fast as Dublin. This likely reflects remote-work-driven demand pushing outward from the capital into regions with a smaller existing housing stock, which absorbs that added demand less elastically — a smaller base means the same number of new buyers moves the index further.

Affordability is genuinely worsening, not just headline prices

Nationally, the house price index grew 17.0% from 2023 to 2025, while average weekly earnings (CSO Earnings & Labour Costs release, all sectors) grew only 10.6% from Q1 2024 to Q1 2026 — a 6.4 percentage-point gap over a comparable recent window. Prices are not just rising; they are rising faster than the incomes that would need to support them.

A note on geography (read before quoting "26 counties")

CSO's Residential Property Price Index does not publish at the level of all 26 individual counties — true county-level sample sizes would be too small for a reliable monthly or annual index. The real published geography is: National, Dublin plus its 4 local authorities (Dublin City, Dún Laoghaire-Rathdown, Fingal, South Dublin), and 7 broader regional groupings (e.g. "Border excluding Louth", "Mid-East including Louth"). This analysis uses that actual geography rather than approximating full county-level granularity that the source data doesn't support.

Recommendation for further work

1. Pair this index data with CSO's median-price-by-Eircode release for a EUR-denominated affordability view alongside the index-based one used here.
2. Extend the earnings comparison back to 2015-2020 using the full EHQ13 quarterly series for a longer affordability trend rather than the 2-year window used here.